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How to block WhatsApp Web and App by Access Rules

Description

When traditional methods such as App Control, and Content Filter Service along with DPI-SSL fail to effectively block WhatsApp Web and the desktop application, the solution proposed in this guide serves as a viable alternative.

Cause

The cause is related most of the times with the number of ports and FQDN/IP addresses WhatsApp communicate with, which makes it more difficult to get it blocked.

Resolution

Resolution for SonicOS 7.X

This release includes significant user interface changes and many new features that are different from the SonicOS 6.5 and earlier firmware. The below resolution is for customers using SonicOS 7.X firmware.

Step 1. Add address objects with the following list:

Refer to the link: [Adding an Address Object](#)

FQDNs:

mmg.whatsapp.net

pps.whatsapp.net

media-iad3-2.cdn.whatsapp.net

media-iad3-1.cdn.whatsapp.net

media-lga3-1.cdn.whatsapp.net

media-lga3-2.cdn.whatsapp.net

crashlogs.whatsapp.net

msedge.api.cdp.microsoft.com

config.edge.skype.com

IPs:

20.99.184.37

157.240.229.61

3.33.221.48

52.143.87.28

52.148.148.114

3.33.252.61

20.112.56.82

20.189.173.6

52.226.139.180

15.197.206.217

FQDNs (optional):

wa.me

whatsapp-plus.info

whatsapp-plus.me

whatsapp-plus.net

whatsapp.cc

whatsapp.com

whatsapp.info

whatsapp.net

whatsapp.org

whatsapp.tv

whatsappbrand.com



NOTE: The FQDNs and IP addresses seen are a result of a LAB environment, that were collected one by one through a packet capture that was running during the LAB test. Moreover, the IP addresses are responsible to prevent the QR Code to pop-up.

Step 2. Now, add those FQDNs and IP addresses into a Group creating an Address Group.

Refer to the link: [Creating Address Groups](#)

Step 3. Add port services, and follow the same as step 2 creating a group of services.

Refer to the link: [Adding Custom IP Type Services](#)

Refer to the link: [Adding Custom Service Groups](#)

Port Services:

TCP 80

TCP 443

TCP 5222

TCP 5223

TCP 5228

TCP 5242

Step 4. It's time to create the Block Access Rule from LAN to WAN:

Editing Rule

Name:

Description:

Action: ☒ Allow ☒ Deny ☐ Discard

Type: ☒ IPv4 ☐ IPv6

Priority:

Schedule:

Enable: ☒

SOURCE

Zone/Interface:

Address:

Port/Services:

DESTINATION

Zone/Interface:

Address:

Port/Services:

Show Diagram: ☐

Cancel Save

TIP: If this rule needs to be applied for specific group of users, the next tab "Users & TCP/UDP provides the right fields to include/exclude the users or group of users.

Editing Rule

Name

Block_WhatsApp

Description

provide a short description of your access rule...

Action

→ Allow

✕ Deny

🛡 Discard

Type

☒ IPv4 ☐ IPv6

Priority

Auto Prioritize

Schedule

Always

Enable

☒

Source / Destination

User & TCP/UDP

Security Profiles

Traffic Shaping

Logging

Optional Settings

USER

Include

All

Exclude

None

TCP / UDP

TCP Inactivity Timeout

15

minutes

UDP Inactivity Timeout

30

seconds

Show Diagram

☐

Cancel

Save

TIP: RESOLUTION FOR SONICOS 6.5 FOLLOWS THE SAME PATTERN.